

AUST CSE Carnival 8.0 — UI/UX Design Sprint · Run of Show

Event: Thu 11 Sep 2026 · 17:00–23:00 (Dhaka) · online · single 6-hour round · team of 1–3 **Submission:** ONE package through the official form before 23:00. Late uploads are not accepted. **External gates (only three):** 17:00 theme drop · 17:40 scenario drop · 23:00 upload closes. Every other boundary is self-enforced. **Compliance:** This file is process only. Nothing is created in Figma before 17:00 (rule 02: no pre-made templates). The Q.01 practice file and its components are off-limits.

0. Rubric economics

Phase	Block	Weight	pts/min	What the judge literally checks (rulebook wording)
1 Brief & user stories	40	10%	0.25	"Is the problem clear? Are the user stories specific and checkable?"
2 Research & user profile	40	15%	0.38	"Did you really use the scenario? Did your user profile and problem list CHANGE from Phase 1 to 2?"
3 Structure & wireframes	50	15%	0.30	"Do the sitemap and wireframes clearly match the user stories?"
4 Screen design	90	25%	0.28	"How good the screens look, and whether the WHOLE journey is covered — not one hero screen."
5 Design file quality	70	15%	0.21	"Auto-layout, consistent colours and fonts, real text, no placeholders."
— Accessibility & usability	(done in 5)	10%	(P5 → 0.36)	"Contrast, alt text, and other accessibility choices are WRITTEN DOWN, not just claimed."
6 Prototype & handoff	50	10%	0.20	"Does the prototype click through end to end? Can someone else use your handoff note?"

- Documents / process / file hygiene = **75%**. Screen visuals = **25%**.
 - Phase 2 is the highest-yield block per minute. Phase 6 is the lowest-yield but has a binary failure mode: "a prototype that does not click through end to end counts as incomplete".
 - Screen Design is scored on coverage first, beauty second. Coverage gate at 20:40.
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1. Clock (17:00 start)

Clock	Phase	Deliverables due	Gate
17:00–17:40	1 Understand	one-page brief · US-1..US-5 with acceptance criteria · 1–2 profiles marked HYPOTHESIS · unknowns list	17:35 soft stop
17:40–18:20	2 Research	scenario write-up with citations · profile CHANGE LOG · P-1..P-5 problems/insights	18:20 hard
18:20–19:10	3 Structure	sitemap · main-journey flow with S-ids · 3–5 wireframes labelled US/P · screen inventory · platform decision	19:10 HARD — Phase 4 starts regardless
19:10–20:40	4 Screens	styles + components first (10 min) · every S-id screen, real text, licensed imagery · one-line note per screen	20:40 coverage gate
20:40–21:50	5 Clean file	consistency pass · palette + type rationale · measured a11y notes · logo · no lorem · pages organised · view link tested	21:50 = minimum viable package exists
21:50–22:40	6 Prototype & handoff	end-to-end prototype · handoff note · PDFs exported · form text pre-filled	22:30 edits freeze
22:40–23:00	Submit	upload at 22:40, confirm receipt, keep copies	23:00

Phone alarms: 17:35 · 18:15 · 19:05 · 20:35 · 21:45 · 22:30 · 22:40.

2. Phase protocols and Definition of Done

Phase 1 — Understand (17:00–17:40) · theme only, no scenario yet

Read the theme twice. Identify: what is being asked, for whom, on what platform (if stated), what the logo/brand implies.

- ☐ **Brief (≤ 1 page):** Problem (1–2 sentences: who, what, why now) · Users (primary, secondary) · Goals (max 3, checkable) · Limits (platform, context, tech, scope OUT).
- ☐ **User stories US-1..US-5:** "As a [user], I want [goal], so that [benefit]" + 1–2 acceptance criteria each ("Done when..."). Every criterion must be observable on a screen.
- ☐ **1–2 user profiles, explicitly labelled HYPOTHESIS.** Fields: context · goals · frustrations · tech comfort · constraints. Tag every field [A] assumption or [I] inferred-from-theme. This sets up the scored Phase 1→2 delta.
- ☐ **Unknowns list:** what the scenario must answer. Becomes Phase 2 reading questions, later handoff "open questions".
- ☐ Start **DECISIONS.md** (see §3).

Phase 2 — Research (17:40–18:20) · scenario is the ONLY user evidence

Pass 1: read straight through, highlight facts. Pass 2: extract actors, goals, pain points, context, constraints, exact phrases.

- ☐ **Write-up "What we learned"**: each learning cites the scenario (quote or line ref) and is tagged [E]. Inference tagged [I]. Nothing invented.
- ☐ **Updated profile with CHANGE LOG**: per field → Confirmed / Changed / Dropped / Added, each with its scenario evidence. If a Phase 1 guess was right, say so and cite why — the judge is scoring visible change.
- ☐ **P-1..P-5 problems/insights**: Evidence → Insight → Design implication. Prioritise P0/P1. Map each to a user story. Revise stories the scenario contradicts and record the revision.
- ☐ Update unknowns list (answered / still open).

Phase 3 — Structure (18:20–19:10) · before any visual design

- ☐ **Sitemap** of main sections (Figma page or FigJam; export PNG).
- ☐ **Main-journey flow**: screens as nodes with IDs S-01...; arrows = the prototype links we will wire in Phase 6. This flow IS the prototype spine.
- ☐ **Wireframes for 3–5 main screens**: greyscale low-fi, no colour, no type styling. Each frame labelled **S-xx · US-x · P-y**.
- ☐ **Screen inventory table**: S-id · name · US · P · must-have content · states (empty/error/success) · in main journey? (Y/N). Decide which states are part of the journey; everything else is out of scope and written as such.
- ☐ **Platform decision** from scenario evidence (mobile 390×844 vs web 1440). Record in DECISIONS.md.
- ☐ **Content plan**: names, places, prices (BDT), dates consistent with the scenario — so Phase 4 has no lorem moments.
- ☐ Trace matrix US → P → S (a small table; reused in handoff).

Phase 4 — Screens (19:10–20:40) · PROTECTED · build clean from the first frame

First 10 minutes, nothing else:

- ☐ Colour styles/variables: brand (derived from the supplied logo) · neutrals · semantic (success/warn/error) · surface/text pairs pre-checked for contrast.
- ☐ Type styles: 1–2 families (Google Fonts; Bangla-capable if evidence says so), 6–7 role-named styles.
- ☐ Spacing 4/8 grid, radius tokens, layout grid on the device frame.
- ☐ Components only the inventory needs: Button (primary/secondary/tertiary + states) · Input (default/focus/error) · Top bar · Bottom nav/tab bar · Card · List row · Toast/dialog.

Then screens, in journey order:

- ☐ Every S-id screen exists as a top-level frame named **S-xx Name**, auto-layout, containers FILL-width, fixed device size.
- ☐ Real text everywhere. Real imagery only from licence-clean sources (see §3). Theme logo placed where a brand would place it.
- ☐ One-line note per screen: "Serves US-x / fixes P-y because ..." (collected into the Phase 4 note).

- ☐ **20:40 coverage gate:** any main-journey screen missing → Phase 5 flex time goes to coverage, not polish.

Phase 5 — Clean file (20:40–21:50) · make it portfolio-grade, add nothing new

- ☐ Consistency pass: no detached colours/fonts, auto-layout on every container, layers named, duplicate components merged, resize test (change frame width — nothing breaks).
- ☐ Palette + font set written down with a one-line reason each (Figma frame + doc).
- ☐ **Accessibility notes (measured, not claimed):**
 - Contrast table: element · fg · bg · ratio · pass (AA: 4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text and UI).
 - Alt text table: screen · image/icon · alt text (or "decorative").
 - Touch targets $\geq 44 \times 44$, ≥ 8 between targets. Body ≥ 16 on mobile.
 - Focus/reading order · errors use icon + text + colour, never colour alone · plain-language microcopy · language choice · motion non-essential.
 - Any scenario-driven choice (low literacy, low bandwidth, shared device...) only if evidenced.
- ☐ Logo present and used correctly. Search file text for "lorem" / "ipsum" / "placeholder" → zero hits. No grey image boxes.
- ☐ Figma pages: **Cover** · 01 Flow & Sitemap · 02 Wireframes · 03 Screens · 04 Design System · 05 Accessibility · 06 Prototype.
- ☐ Share link: **Anyone with the link → can view.** Tested in an incognito window.
- ☐ **21:50 checkpoint:** every rubric line has a submittable artefact, even if rough.

Phase 6 — Prototype & handoff (21:50–22:40)

- ☐ Flow starting point on the first screen. Every main-journey screen has a forward link and a back link. Overlays/scroll where the journey needs them.
- ☐ Run it end to end in presentation mode. Zero dead ends. Re-test the prototype share link in incognito.
- ☐ **Handoff note (1 page):** product one-liner · primary user · main flows as S-id sequences per US · component + token summary · states covered / explicitly not covered · open questions (from unknowns) · dev notes (data, validation, empty/error handling) · assets & licences · AI-usage statement + pointer to DECISIONS.md.
- ☐ Export PDFs (brief, research, sitemap/wireframes, Phase 4 note, handoff). Paste all links into **SUBMISSION.md** (pre-filled form text).
- ☐ **22:30 freeze.** No more edits to the Figma file after this.

Submit (22:40–23:00)

- ☐ Upload at 22:40. Confirm receipt. Screenshot the confirmation. Keep local copies of every file and link.

3. Standing rules (all phases)

Evidence tagging in every document: **[E]** evidence (theme/scenario text) · **[I]** inference · **[A]** assumption · **[D]** design implication. Judges are told to check that later decisions come from the scenario.

Decision log (`DECISIONS.md`, live from 17:00) — every major decision as: `DL-nn · PROBLEM → EVIDENCE → INSIGHT → USER NEED → DECISION → EXPECTED BENEFIT` Rule 03 says we must be able to explain any decision; the tools policy says prompts, edits and decisions are what get judged. The log is the answer to both, attached to the handoff.

Assets & licences (rule 04: uncredited work = disqualification; rubric: "no placeholders"):

- Fonts: Google Fonts only. Icons: one set, permissive licence (Material Symbols / Lucide / Phosphor). Photos: Unsplash plugin only, record photographer + URL, or none. Illustrations: drawn in Figma. Logo: as supplied by organisers.
- Never: screenshots of other apps, Dribbble/Behance copies, stock without licence, unlabelled AI images.
- Credit list goes in the handoff note.

Real text: every string is plausible product copy consistent with the scenario (names, BDT prices, dates, locations). No lorem, no "Title here", no "Lorem" avatars.

Figma build discipline (learned in the Q.01 dry run, Figma MCP):

- One top-level frame per `use_figma` call; batch everything for that screen in one call.
- Unknown props fail the whole call (`alignItems`, `verticalPadding`, `padding: 0`, strokes on ellipse, empty-string text, `strokes: undefined`). Use `primaryAxisAlignItems` / `counterAxisAlignItems`.
- Text wrapping: `layoutSizingHorizontal: 'FILL' + textAutoResize: 'HEIGHT'`.
- Variant text via `setProperties`. Prototype links via `node.setReactionsAsync + page.flowStartingPoints`.
- Budget: **200 MCP calls/day, 10 reads/min**. Plan $\approx$ wireframes 6 · system 3 · screens 12 · fixes 20 · a11y/reads 15 · prototype 4 $\approx$ 60. Failed calls still count — no speculative props.

Time discipline: required deliverable > core journey > major UX problems > hierarchy > visual quality > system consistency > edge cases > decoration. Nothing from Phases 1–3 may run into 19:10.

Solo operating model (team = Tayeb + Copilot; decided 2026-09-10):

- Tayeb owns every decision and can explain each one (rule 03). Copilot drafts, challenges, builds, audits — never decides alone.
- Phases 1–3: Copilot drafts documents from Tayeb's answers and the scenario; Tayeb edits and approves. Wireframes = Figma low-fi frames via MCP (greyscale, labelled), so they become Phase 4 skeletons.
- Phase 4: Copilot builds styles/components then one screen per `use_figma` call while Tayeb does visual QA and manual fixes in Figma in parallel. Docs are paused; only the one-line screen notes are captured.
- Phase 5: Copilot runs the consistency/a11y audit (reads) and writes the palette/type/a11y docs; Tayeb fixes in Figma.
- Phase 6: Copilot wires reactions via MCP; Tayeb clicks through end to end and reports dead ends; Copilot drafts the handoff; Tayeb finalises and uploads.
- Docs pipeline: Markdown in this workspace → **Markdown PDF (yzane) rendering with local Edge** (configured in `.vscode/settings.json`; no Chromium download). Sitemap on a Figma

page → PNG export.

- MCP budget is the production engine: keep ≥ 40 calls in reserve at 21:50.

4. Submission package (what the form must receive)

Phase	Artefact	Format
1	Brief + user stories + hypothesis profiles	PDF
2	Research notes + updated profile (change log) + problem list	PDF
3	Sitemap + wireframes	PNG/PDF
4	Finished screens (export PNG set) + per-screen note	PNG + PDF
5	Figma file link — view access enabled	link
6	Prototype link + one-page handoff note (with decision log + licences)	link + PDF

5. Pre-flight (tonight / before 16:30 tomorrow) — tools and process only

- ☐ Registration confirmed (deadline was 7 Sep). Team roster final. Everyone has read the rulebook.
 - ☐ Submission form link obtained; accepted file types and size limits known. **Tayeb asks organisers tonight (see §6);** record answers here.
 - ☐ Figma: login works; a new file can be created in the team; "Anyone with the link → can view" is permitted on this plan; prototype sharing works. Plugins installed: contrast checker (Stark or Contrast), Unsplash, Iconify, Autoflow. **No files, pages, styles or components created.**
 - ☒ Figma MCP: **whoami** OK on 2026-09-10 — Mohammed Tayeb, student tier, Full seat, 200 calls/day, 10/min.
 - ☐ Docs pipeline tested: open **SPRINT-OPS.md** → Ctrl+Shift+P → **Markdown PDF: Export (pdf)** → **SPRINT-OPS.pdf** appears next to it. Extension **yzane.markdown-pdf** is installed; **.vscode/settings.json** points it at local Edge so no Chromium download happens at 22:45. Fallback: Markdown Preview Enhanced → Chrome (Puppeteer) → PDF, or browser print-to-PDF.
 - ☒ Workspace settings override user settings that map ***.md** → **bat** with format-on-save (found 2026-09-10; that combination hides Markdown commands and has corrupted files before).
 - ☒ Wireframe method: Figma low-fi frames via MCP (decided 2026-09-10).
 - ☒ Workspace scaffold: **01-understand ... 06-handoff, DECISIONS.md, SUBMISSION.md** (process files only, no design content).
 - ☐ Alarms set (see §1). Shared clock synced.
 - ☐ Backup internet (mobile hotspot), charger, water/food, quiet room, second monitor if available.
 - ☐ Fresh workspace: this folder only. Do not open **e:\carnival-uiux** or the Q.01 Figma file during the sprint.
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6. Open questions for organisers (Rubayet 01620929190 · Ma-Huan 01533514667)

1. Is it a single package upload at the end, or are there per-phase check-ins / timestamps?
 2. Accepted file types and size limits on the form? Is a Drive folder link acceptable?
 3. Will a brand name and logo be supplied with the theme ("the theme's logo used" in Phase 5)? Or does this mean the Carnival logo?
 4. Any platform constraint (mobile / web / either)?
 5. Is Figma version history reviewed for rule 02 (work within the window)?
 6. Prototype link: Figma prototype URL acceptable, or must it be the file link with a flow?
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7. Rulebook facts (reference)

- Six phases, one continuous sitting, 17:00–23:00 online. Theme released at 00:00; scenario released at start of Phase 2 (00:40).
- Team 1–3, current AUST students, any department. No fee.
- Rules: 01 follow the released theme · 02 all work original and produced within the window, no pre-made templates · 03 AI allowed, must explain any decision · 04 plagiarism / uncredited work = disqualification · 05 comply with theme and guidelines.
- Tools suggested, never required. Figma or Adobe XD file link, view access enabled.
- Prizes: 2,500 / 1,500 / 1,000 BDT.
- Organisers may alter rules during the event — re-read any announcement at 17:00 and 17:40.